

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Wednesday, 12 August 2026 · 20:06 IST
Prepared by Kore.ai Competitive Intelligence

Bottom line: Competitors are focusing on expanding AI agent capabilities and partnerships, but gaps remain in true omnichannel integration and predictable cost models, presenting clear opportunities for Kore.ai's validated, full-scope platform.

Cresta Partners for Broader CX AI Reach

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-11) Cresta announced a partnership with Firstsource Solutions to accelerate AI-powered customer experience transformation, aiming to enhance AI agent capabilities and customer engagement. [Morningstar](#)

WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI
This partnership highlights Cresta's continued focus on expanding its reach, but it underscores their reliance on partners for broader enterprise deployment, a gap Kore.ai fills with its native omnichannel capabilities and extensive integration ecosystem.

NICE Expands Customer Engagement with Currys

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-12) NICE announced that Currys has transformed its customer engagement using NICE, resulting in higher Net Promoter Score (NPS) and faster resolution times. [Business Wire](#) **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
While NICE highlights positive customer outcomes, their focus remains on their existing CCaaS platform. Kore.ai's agentic AI platform offers a more comprehensive, AI-native approach that drives deeper automation and better TCO, rather than incremental improvements on a legacy seat-based model.

IBM Strengthens Governance with watsonx Orchestrate

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-11) IBM announced new "Enforcement Tracking" capabilities for watsonx Orchestrate, designed to help organizations manage governance policies and ensure proof of compliance. [IBM](#) **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
IBM's focus on governance is a positive step, but it highlights the inherent complexity and potential for drift in LLM-based agentic systems. Kore.ai's ABL provides compile-time validation and deterministic execution, offering a more robust and inherently governed approach to agent behavior, reducing the need for complex post-hoc enforcement.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
------------	--------------	--------	-----------------

Cresta	(2026-08-11) Partnered with Firstsource for AI-powered CX transformation - Morningstar	Med	Native omnichannel and platform breadth vs. partner reliance
NICE	(2026-08-12) Currys transforms customer engagement with NICE - Business Wire	Med	AI-native platform with superior TCO vs. incremental CCaaS enhancements
IBM Agent Platform	(2026-08-11) Enforcement Tracking for watsonx Orchestrate - IBM	Low	Compile-time validation and deterministic execution vs. post-hoc governance

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- Agentforce's continued push into voice and contact center, and how it integrates with third-party telephony partners.
- Parloa's expansion beyond Europe and any new analyst validation for their platform.
- Further details on IBM's "agentic control plane" strategy and its integration with third-party LLMs.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Emphasize Kore.ai's **native omnichannel capabilities** in all voice and digital customer interactions, contrasting with partners-reliant or voice-first approaches.
- Highlight Kore.ai's **predictable cost-per-outcome model** and compile-time validation as key differentiators against consumption-based pricing and post-hoc governance.
- Reinforce Kore.ai's **leader placement in key CX conversational AI analyst evaluations** (Gartner, Forrester) as proof of platform maturity and breadth.
- Arm sales teams with specific questions that probe competitors' reliance on third-party voice infrastructure and their governance models' ability to prevent LLM drift.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- (2026-08-12) Currys Transforms Customer Engagement with NiCE, Driving Higher NPS and Faster Resolution - Business Wire
- (2026-08-11) Firstsource and Cresta Partner to Accelerate AI-Powered Customer Experience Transformation - Morningstar
- (2026-08-11) From governance policies to governance proof with Enforcement Tracking for watsonx Orchestrate - IBM